THE CAUCASIAN CHALK CIRCLE

Set & lighting storyboard / Sumner Theatre / Prologue and all five acts

15 SELECTED STATES
A1 LANDSCAPE | 841 x 594 mm
DIGITAL MODEL RENDERS

PROLOGUE 01 · ACT I 02-04 · ACT II 05-07 · ACT III 08-10 · ACT IV 11-12 · ACT V 13-15



01 PROLOGUE

PROLOGUE | PDF pp. 8-12

SCRIPT Villagers discuss land and rebuilding with the Expert before the Singer introduces their play.

SET Low blocks form an open gathering place. Frames and panels remain exposed around the shared floor.

LIGHT Soft diagonal daylight reaches the group; a warmer side light identifies the Singer.



02 MARKET SQUARE

ACT I | PDF pp. 13-15

SCRIPT On Easter Sunday, the Governor's family passes the petitioners on its way to church.

SET Two large boxes raise the rulers above the crowd. Brick-faced triangles suggest the town's buildings.

LIGHT Angled gold light catches the high platform; low blue side light picks out the petitioners.



03 THE COUP

ACT I | PDF pp. 20-23

SCRIPT The guards turn against the Governor. Soldiers lead him away as the servants flee.

SET Frames turn across the space and blocks scatter, breaking the order of the previous scene.

LIGHT Low red light and sharp blue-white crosslight cast large, conflicting shadows across the curtain.



04 GRUSHA'S CHOICE

ACT I | PDF pp. 29-32

SCRIPT Grusha watches the abandoned Michael through the night and carries him away at dawn.

SET Scenery retreats to the sides, leaving Grusha and the child alone beside a low block.

LIGHT A small warm pool at the child meets a narrow, cold dawn light across the floor.



05 THE FARMHOUSE

ACT II | PDF pp. 46-48

SCRIPT Grusha returns for Michael, strikes the Sergeant with a piece of wood and escapes with the child.

SET An open box and timber frame make a doorway, with the confrontation outside and the baby within.

LIGHT Cold side light cuts into the warm doorway as the soldiers threaten the refuge.



06 THE MOUNTAIN STREAM

ACT II | PDF pp. 48-49

SCRIPT Beside the frozen stream, Grusha replaces Michael's fine linen with rags and makes him her own.

SET The two triangular panels meet at an angle; a low block supports the child.

LIGHT Blue light skims the floor as water; a pale local beam keeps mother and child visible.



07 THE FOOTBRIDGE

ACT II | PDF pp. 49-51

SCRIPT Grusha carries Michael across the failing bridge. The soldiers cannot follow her over it.

SET Blocks of different heights stand high-low-high on one floor. Passed blocks move aside, interrupting the route.

LIGHT Low blue crosslight reveals the steps; a narrow white beam finds Grusha on the far side.



08 LAVRENTI'S HOUSE

ACT III | PDF pp. 53-55

SCRIPT Lavrenti offers his exhausted sister shelter, while Aniko keeps her at a distance.

SET Two open boxes make the family interior. Grusha and Michael remain outside its warm centre.

LIGHT Amber light stays inside; cold side light separates the mother and child from the household.



09 THE WEDDING

ACT III | PDF pp. 58-60

SCRIPT A Monk marries Grusha to the apparently dying Jussup. Lavrenti holds Michael during the ceremony.

SET Low blocks make the bed. Timber-faced panels divide the sickroom from the space around the bride.

LIGHT Sickly yellow light falls on Jussup; a tight cold beam isolates Grusha from the warmer ceremony.



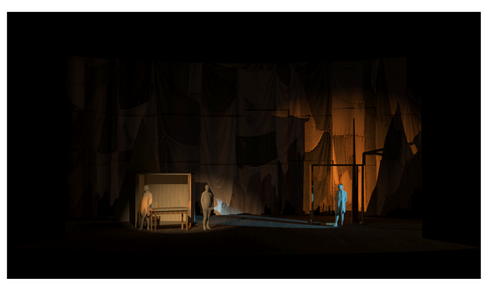
10 REUNION / SEPARATION

ACT III | PDF pp. 68-71

SCRIPT Simon returns and misunderstands Grusha's situation. Soldiers then seize Michael under a court order.

SET The lovers face each other across a light-defined stream. A rear frame marks the child's exit.

LIGHT Blue divides the lovers; cold white light shifts attention to the soldiers and child behind them.



11 AZDAK'S HUT

ACT IV | PDF pp. 72-75

SCRIPT The story returns two years to the rebellion. Azdak shelters a fugitive, unknowingly helping the Grand Duke.

SET One open box, a panel, a table and a chair form the hut; Shauva waits outside.

LIGHT Low amber light holds the conversation; a cold side beam separates Shauva from the refuge.



12 AZDAK BECOMES JUDGE

ACT IV | PDF pp. 81-84

SCRIPT After the mock trial, the soldiers choose Azdak as judge, putting robes on him and a basket on his head.

SET An ordinary chair and stacked open frames form an improvised, uneven court.

LIGHT Low amber light throws an oversized shadow; blue backlight outlines the frame behind him.



13 THE TRIAL

ACT V | PDF pp. 96-101

SCRIPT Grusha defends the care she has given Michael; the Governor's Wife's claim is tied to his inheritance.

SET The two sides face each other across open floor. Azdak's table and chair sit off-centre behind them.

LIGHT Separate pale and blue side lights divide the claimants; a warmer area identifies the judge.



14 THE CIRCLE TEST

ACT V | PDF pp. 103-105

SCRIPT Grusha lets go in both tests rather than hurt Michael. Azdak awards her the child; this frame shows the decision.

SET The same bridge blocks form a circle: low at the front, high behind, with clear views inside.

LIGHT Warm side light finds Grusha; amber backlight outlines the blocks while the judge remains visible.



15 THE FAREWELL DANCE

ACT V | PDF pp. 105-106

SCRIPT Grusha is freed from her marriage. The couples dance, gradually obscuring Azdak until he disappears.

SET The block circle stays. Azdak is shown leaving through a gap in the rear curtain; his chair remains.

LIGHT A warm overhead spot holds the dancers; a quieter cool beam reveals Azdak's departure.

SCRIPT = paraphrased action in the play. SET / LIGHT = proposed staging. Read left to right, then continue on the next row.

State 10 combines consecutive events; state 14 shows the decision after the second test. Moving bridge blocks and the raised block circle are design interpretations.

Source: Bertolt Brecht, The Caucasian Chalk Circle, translated by Alistair Beaton, Bloomsbury Methuen Drama. References use page numbers in the supplied PDF, including its front matter.